

Developer Workforce & Compensation Trends

2024 Stack Overflow Survey

65,437 respondents across 180+ countries

Source: survey.stackoverflow.co/2024/work

84% of Developers Are Working, but Full-Time Employment Dips in the U.S.

Global Employment Breakdown

- 84% of the 65,437 respondents are currently working (full-time, part-time, or freelancing).
- Full-time employment dominates at 69%.
- Independent contracting / freelancing: 16.4%.
- Full-time students: 13.2%.

U.S. Shift

- U.S. full-time employment dropped from 69% in 2023 to 64.8% in 2024.
- Freelancing and contracting remain significant at 16%+.

Regional Nuances

- In the U.K. and Ukraine, non-full-time respondents lean toward independent contracting.
- In Germany and India, they are more likely to be full-time students.

In-Person Work Rises to 20% While Hybrid Holds Steady at 42%

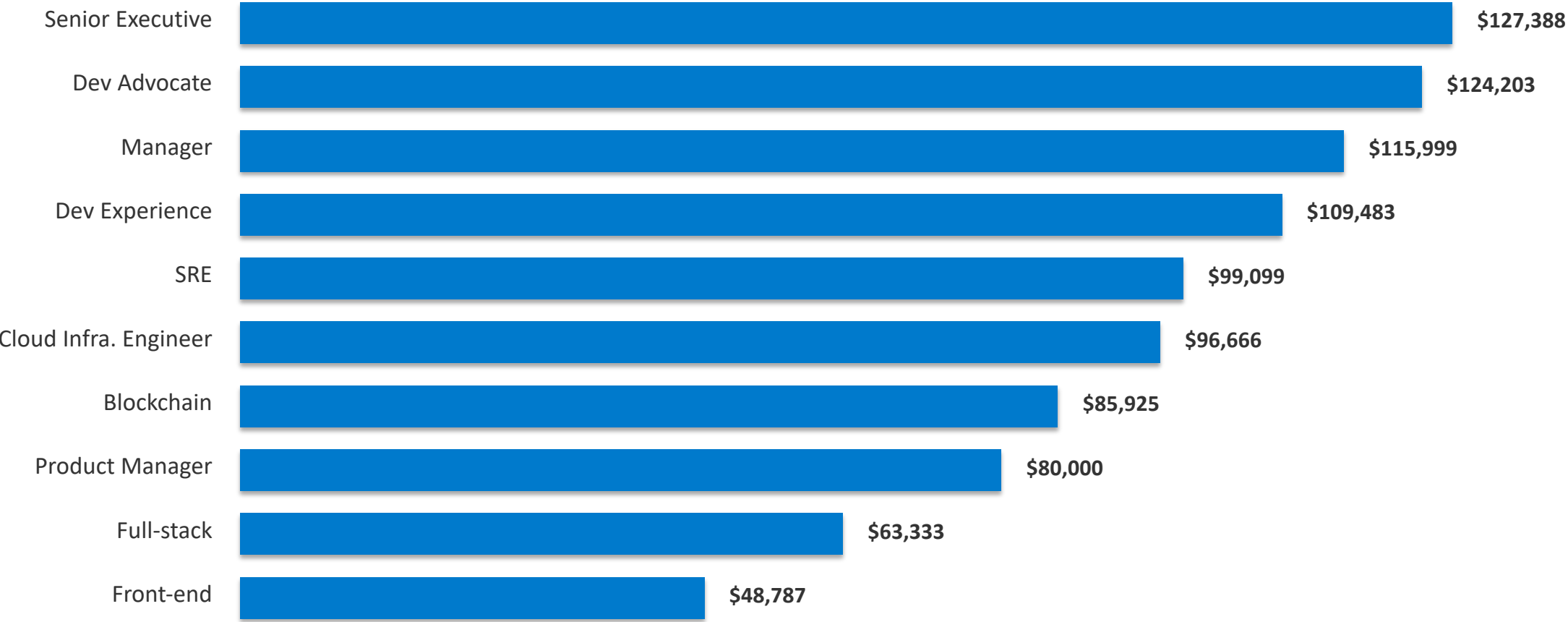
Work Arrangement Trends (2022–2024)

- Hybrid work remains the most common arrangement at 42%, consistent with 2023.
- Remote work accounts for 38%.
- In-person work has risen for the third consecutive year:
 - 15% in 2022
 - 16% in 2023
 - 20% in 2024

Implication

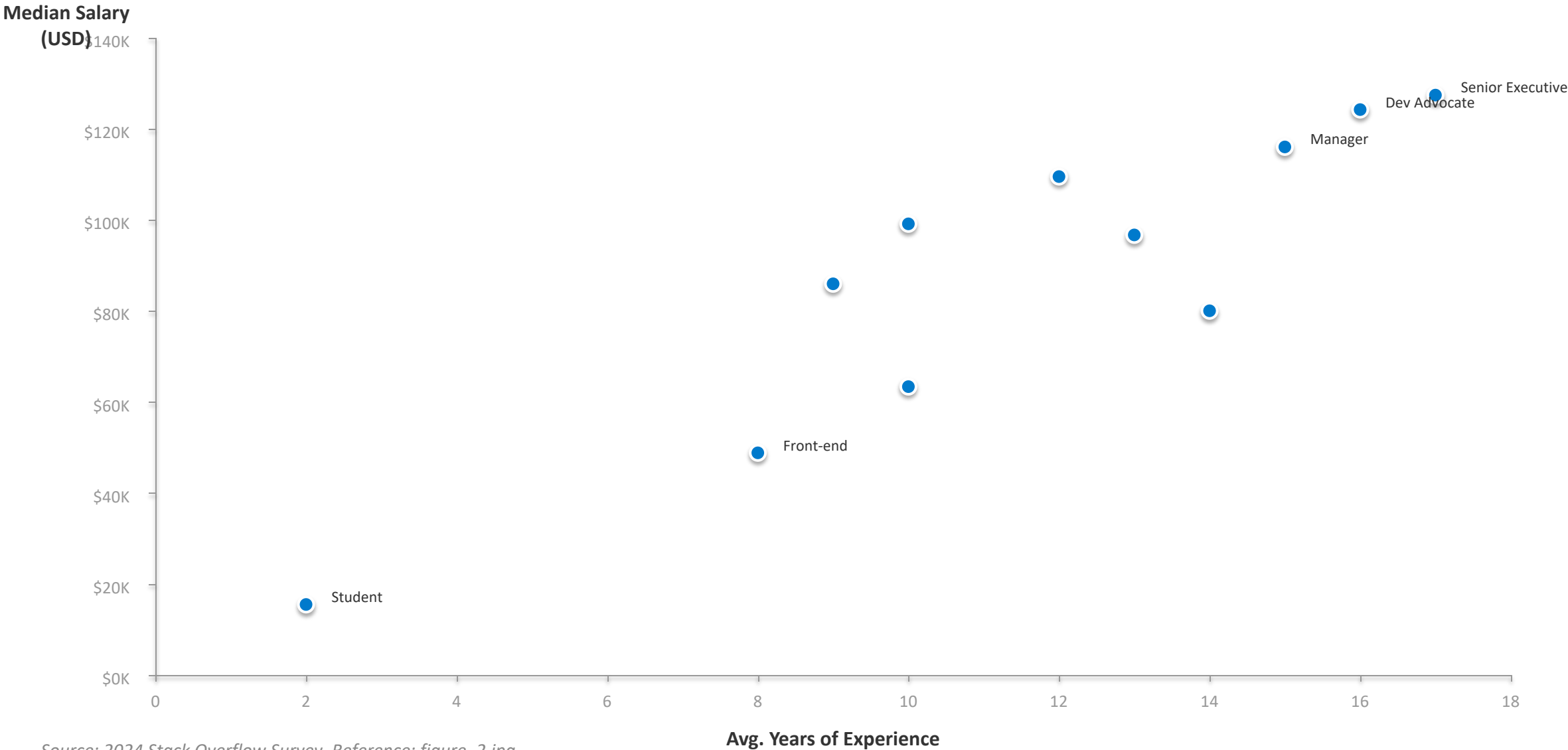
- A gradual return-to-office trend is underway, though hybrid still dominates.
- Engineering leaders should plan for flexible policies that retain talent while accommodating RTO pressure.

Senior Executives and Dev Advocates Top \$124K+ Median Salary



Source: 2024 Stack Overflow Survey (22,677 salary responses, 34.7% response rate). Reference: figure_1.jpg

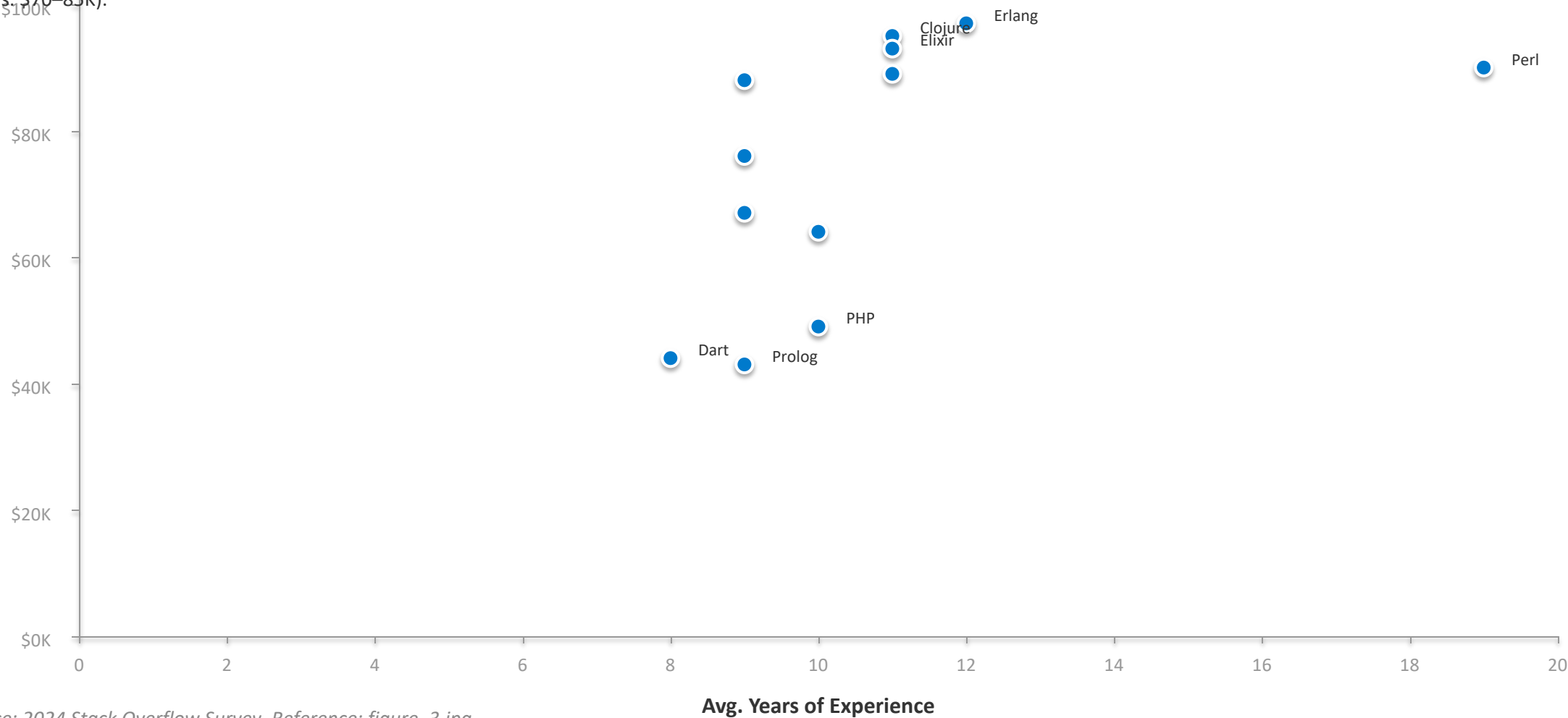
Experience Pays: Top Roles Combine 14+ Years with Six-Figure Salaries



Erlang & Clojure Developers Earn >\$95K; Dart & Prolog Below \$45K

Median Salary

(USD)
Overall reported salary range
dropped ~\$10K vs. 2023 (\$60–
75K vs. \$70–85K).



Source: 2024 Stack Overflow Survey. Reference: figure_3.jpg

47% Work at Sub-100 Orgs; 62% Influence Tech Purchases

Company Size Distribution

Freelancer / solo: 6.1%
2–9 employees: 10.4%
10–19 employees: 8.9%
20–99 employees: 21.2%
100–499 employees: 18.5%
500–999 employees: 6.7%
1,000–4,999 employees: 11.0%
5,000–9,999 employees: 3.8%
10,000+ employees: 11.4%

47% of respondents work for organizations with fewer than 100 employees (n = 42,827).

Technology Purchasing Influence

- 62% of respondents have influence over technology purchases at their organizations.
- Senior executives: 99%
- Engineering managers: 87%
- Product managers: 77%
- 60% prefer a build-and-buy approach over purely building or buying.
- 75% start with a free trial when evaluating new tools.
- 73% ask other developers for opinions during evaluation.

Takeaways: What These Trends Mean for Hiring & Retention

1. Full-time employment is softening

Plan for a larger contractor/freelance mix. U.S. full-time rates fell from 69% to 64.8% YoY; freelancing holds at 16%+ globally.

2. In-person mandates are growing, but hybrid still dominates

In-person work climbed to 20% (from 15% in 2022). Retention strategies should emphasize flexibility while accommodating RTO trends.

3. DevRel and SRE roles command premium pay

Senior Executives (\$127K), Dev Advocates (\$124K), and SREs (\$99K) top the charts. Expect to pay six figures for senior leadership and reliability expertise.

4. Language choice correlates with pay — niche languages pay more

Erlang, Clojure, and Elixir developers earn >\$93K median, while mainstream JavaScript and PHP sit well below \$65K. Budget accordingly for specialized stacks.

5. Most developers influence purchasing — engage them directly

62% have a say in tech buying decisions; 75% start with free trials. Vendor strategies should target individual contributors, not just management.